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VIT BHOPAL

PROJECT REPORT

Digital Literacy

Name: Prem Kumar

Registration number:25BAI10412

Course Code: CSE0001

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INTRODUCTION

In an era where professional and personal lives are inextricably linked to digital platforms, digital literacy has transitioned from a technical skill to a fundamental necessity. Through this project, my objective is to bridge the gap between basic internet usage and professional digital fluency.

Task 1

For the first task, I focused on the power of visual communication by creating a comprehensive infographic using **Canva**. The primary goal was to define "Digital Literacy" not just as a technical skill, but as a critical life skill in the modern age. My infographic broke down the core pillars of digital literacy, specifically tailoring the content to help fellow students. I curated list of useful digital tools that can students in day-to-day life and tools which I use and trust myself.

Along just listing tools I also included some safe internet practices. In an era where information is everywhere, knowing how to browse securely is vital. I used *cyber themed background* and concise text with a font that reminds one of *orbitron* to explain safe internet practices. This task was a fun, using **Canva** to create concise infographic taught me how to take complex technical information and turn it into something easy to read and visually engaging. It made me realize that being digitally literate also means being able to teach others through clear, professional design. By the end of this task, I felt much more confident in my ability to use cloud-based design software like **Canva** to share important ideas.

Task 2

In Task 2, I focused on building a professional foundation by setting up accounts on **GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle**. I chose GitHub to host my future coding projects and version control history. On GitHub, I created a profile README that introduces me and my branch, I used LinkedIn to start my professional networking journey, carefully filling out my education section with my current degree and expected graduation year. Finally, I chose Kaggle because my domain and field is linked with data science; data and datasets are crucial to Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning and want a platform where I can practice with real-world datasets and join global competitions.

Over the next four years, I plan to use these platforms as a tool and record of my activities and projects. GitHub will be my *technical archive* where I commit code and learn about new interesting projects, while LinkedIn will help me stay updated on industry trends and internships. Kaggle will be my playground for sharpening my analytical skills. This task made me realize that a digital presence is a necessity to keep up with the digital age. I kept my profiles minimal and professional, using my college email for most sign-ups. I've

documented this setup with screenshots in the task-2-portfolio/ folder, marking the official start of my professional digital identity.

Task 3

For the third task, I explored tools that facilitate both individual practice and team collaboration. In **Part A**, I used **HackerRank** to tackle my first coding challenge. I completed beginner-level problems starting with your introductory *Hello world* program to arithmetic operations with constraints. It was a great way to get used to an online "Judge" system and understand how competitive programming platforms work. It gave me the feeling of being assessed in a professional interview where the invigilator is testing all use and test cases of my code. This experience showed me how essential these platforms are for building the problem-solving speed required for technical interviews.

In **Part B**, I switched to **Google forms** to create a "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz". I designed exactly five questions, about digital literacy its awareness and a bit of history of digital literacy awareness in India. I even linked the form to a Google Sheet to track responses in real-time. These tools are incredibly helpful academically because they allow for seamless data collection and group projects. Whether I am practicing code on CodeChef or organizing a survey for a group assignment on Google Forms, these platforms make me a more efficient student. I have shared the form link in my README and stored the screenshots of my badges and response sheets in the task-3-platforms/ folder.

Task 4

This task focused on the "soft skills" of the digital world but crucial nonetheless. I drafted two professional emails: one to a professor requesting a deadline extension and another to an internship coordinator expressing interest in a summer role. These exercises taught me the importance of a clear subject line and a respectful tone. Beyond emailing, I created a **Social Media Checklist** with 10 points (5 Do's and 5 Don'ts) to help college students maintain a clean digital presence.

Communication might be a soft skill to some but it is essential even in field of technology. Proper communication is what ensures proper execution. Smooth operation can only happen when the team members communicate properly. It is essential to send the *right* message through your words and actions. It is necessary to ensure proper communication even in the digital space as miscommunication can lead to unwanted discourse and hindrances in operations. An example oof how poor communication in digital landscape can lead to unprecedented harm would be with **YandereDev.** For years, the developer released long, detailed "*progress report*" videos for his game *Yandere Simulator* that often used condescending language toward his own audience. When fans asked simple questions about why the game was taking so long or why the code was inefficient, he often responded with improper words that framed his fans as a burden or "*harassers*." This defensive stance created

a toxic cycle where genuine technical feedback was met with bans or public call-outs, turning a viral indie project into a decade-long "*development hell*" and everyone turning there backs on the game.

Task-5

Cybercrime awareness is crucial for online safety and integral part of Digital Literacy. In this task I did a case study on WannaCry ransomware attack and a Stay safe online checklist.

The most surprising aspect of researching the **WannaCry ransomware** attack was discovering that the entire global disaster was largely preventable. It was shocking to learn that the vulnerability used **EternalBlue** which had already been patched by Microsoft two months before the outbreak occurred. The "catastrophe" could have been prevented if thousands of major organizations, including the UK's National Health Service, had simply update their systems. Realizing that a single "click" on a patch could have saved billions of dollars and protected critical healthcare infrastructure highlights how thin the line is between digital safety and total collapse.

This case study helped me realize to ensure what software I use is protected or less prone to attacks or not. I will now exercise caution and update my software accordingly while reading the patchnotes for the updates and community feedback

All in all this was an insightful project which helped hone my digital skills even further. Reflecting upon it, I will try to improve upon them even after submitting my project.